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Artificial intelligence technologies have the capacity to improve human civilization and life if they are created and used responsibly, but pose serious risks should they go awry, including dictatorship and extreme socioeconomic inequality. To ensure we reap the benefits of these technologies rather than suffer their drawbacks, the United States must take significant action to ensure all artificial intelligence technologies are developed, tested, and used in a manner consistent with the principles of open-source technology. Such measures include: - Strengthening the rights of copyright holders to decide if, when, and how their property is used for the purposes of training artificial intelligence models, allowing for business-crushing penalties to be levied against artificial intelligence companies should these rules be violated. - Prohibiting Federal funds from being used for the purpose of developing or implementing any closed-source artificial intelligence technologies, including for the purposes of "defense" or "national security". - Declaring non-disclosure agreements and other measures used to silence employees of artificial intelligence companies void as contrary to public policy, including those which restrict or prohibit employees from releasing "confidential" intellectual property to the People such that it cannot be monopolized and abused. - Prohibit artificial intelligence companies who have recently been found to have infringed the intellectual property rights of content creators from taking legal action against others on the basis of intellectual property theft (e.g., suing a competitor who recently released a more energy-efficient large language model) If used properly, artificial intelligence technologies will improve our lives and strengthen the power of the People to defend our rights. If abused, artificial intelligence technologies will exacerbate income inequality, impede our democratic political systems, and strengthen the power of the wealthy few to unilaterally control the ideas and direction of society. For these reasons, it is imperative that swift, decisive action is taken to ensure artificial intelligence technologies become (and remain) open source. Note: "open source" includes the principles of "libre" and "gratis" as traditionally understood within the open source community.